



September 24th 2019 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2VIE20s4tDI
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Target Category	delaware_county

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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Powell, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Alexander, and Mr. Mallory (Note: Names are transcribed phonetically from roll call and discussion turns).
 - **Members Absent:** Not explicitly stated.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the Council President.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** A moment of silence was observed to remember a fallen county employee and provide time for staff counseling.
- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:02:00 Approval of the minutes for August was moved, seconded, and approved by roll call vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:25 Financial & Transfer Agenda Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Finance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed various departmental budget adjustments, line-item transfers, and corrections. Corrections were noted for overtime, capital improvement funds, and specific departmental accounts (including Health Department, Plan Commission, Circuit Court, Communications, Jail, Clerk, Elections, EMS, and Highway).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (unanimous/yes responses recorded across members).
- **00:35:40 New Job Description: Peer Recovery Coach (Community Corrections)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thomas / HR.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction and review of the job description for a Peer Recovery Coach within Delaware County Community Corrections. The position is designed to aid case managers by providing 200<U+2013>300 hours of direct intervention per inmate (assisting with food stamps, insurance sign-ups, etc.) to satisfy program requirements. Council members discussed broader societal issues, public safety, and the continuous flow of inmates into facilities.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:39:33 Resolution 2019-03-04: Delaware Circuit Court Number Six**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Presiding Officer, joined by Judge Marianne Murphy (Presiding Judge, Delaware Circuit Courts), Emily Anderson (Court Administrator), and Eric Hoffman (Delaware County Prosecutor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate regarding proposed Resolution 2019-03-04, which acknowledges the judges' request to the Indiana General Assembly for the creation of Delaware Circuit Court Number Six (assuming/impacting the Muncie City Court structure), but states the county council's inability to assume funding obligations due to property tax circuit breakers and fiscal constraints.
 - Judge Murphy and Prosecutor Hoffman testified regarding the inefficiencies of the current "trial de novo" system with the Muncie City Court, noting that domestic violence victims and witnesses must testify twice, cases face severe delays, and a unified circuit court would streamline justice and capture revenue (probation fees, tax intercepts).
 - Council members (including Mr. Ballard and Mr. Bledsoe) expressed deep fiscal concern, citing upcoming major financial burdens, including impending costs for the new jail, communication center funding shifts (approx. \$1 million), and declining Local Income Tax (LIT) revenues.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Judge Marianne Murphy and Prosecutor Eric Hoffman spoke extensively against the restrictive language of the resolution, arguing that a

unified court would be a financial wash or revenue generator over time and that opposing it would kill legislative viability.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** 01:48:32 A motion to **table** Resolution 2019-03-04 for 30 days to allow council members (specifically Scott and Ryan) time to meet with judges and review 2018 financial/revenue reports was **Approved** by roll call vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *(No general public comment or citizen forum period was conducted outside of the specific agenda items and official testimony detailed in Section 4.)*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - 01:49:38 Recognition of a Delaware County advanced EMT honored by the State Fire Marshal at the emergency response conference.
 - The council announced a brief recess before reconvening as the annual budget body.
- **Adjournment:** 01:59:06 The regular meeting was recessed for ten minutes prior to reconvening for annual budget proceedings.

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